

A key feature of using real estate as an investment vehicle is increased control over your outcomes. Chad “Coach” Carson went all in on real estate, using it both to make a living and as his primary investment vehicle to build wealth. His success enabled him to reach FI in his mid-thirties. He sees this increased control over your outcomes as a double-edged sword. The benefit of having more control is that you can reach FI sooner. You just have to work harder, learn faster, and keep hustling. The flip side is that everything goes through you. You have to be willing to put in the work. You have to add value to each deal. This can be intimidating to a new real estate investor, unsure where to get started.

Carson noted that real estate investing doesn’t have to be an all-or-nothing path. Many people can benefit from owning just one or two investment properties. Once owned free and clear, they can produce several thousand dollars per month. Combined with a low-cost lifestyle, this could be enough to allow someone to be FI or at least reduce the burden on their passive investment accounts by producing steady monthly income. Combining real estate investing with the FI mindset differentiates this path of investing from what many real estate investors do. Many are constantly looking for the next deal, taking on tremendous amounts of risky debt in the process